

Above the law?

Content plan

Arvid Scarff · Berghs Growth Toolbox

The idea

72% of surveyed US registered voters want more investigations and prosecutions in the Epstein case. What does that demand look like beyond a poll?

The project looks at demand for accountability and recorded protest activity. The earlier protest records give us a reason to investigate, but do not show how people acted on the demand measured in 2026.

Who I want to reach

Journalists covering US politics, justice or protest movements. This is a chosen audience, not a researched persona. They could use the findings as a starting point for reporting on how calls for accountability become sustained public pressure.

The message

There is strong stated demand for accountability in the Epstein case. The protest records raise a question about what helps turn that demand into sustained public pressure. They do not prove that people failed to act.

The story I can support

Navigator found that 72% of surveyed US registered voters chose more investigations and prosecutions in February 2026. Separately, our analysis of Crowd Counting Consortium records found 491 US protest event-days with Epstein-related demands in 2025, compared with 8,953 for Gaza / Palestinian solidarity. The full comparison includes seven issues, so readers can see more than the most striking pair.

These are different periods and demands. Most Epstein protest records concern disclosure or cover-ups, not explicit prosecution. An event-day is one recorded protest on one date, not a person; categories can overlap. The figures cannot tell us what share of supporters protested, rank how much people care, or establish anyone's guilt. Sources and full methods are in the article's data companion.

Journalistic angle

What helps turn calls for accountability into sustained public pressure? The contrast offers a starting point for a journalist to investigate, rather than an answer about why people do or do not protest. Reporting could explore how organisers, clear demands and news coverage shape public action. Protest evidence from the same period as the poll would be needed to examine that relationship more closely.

Content and clarity

Chosen content

A short, chart-led article: introduces the finding, shows the comparison and explains the question it raises. It gives a journalist a readable starting point without treating the figures as proof of inaction.

An interactive dashboard: lets the reader explore all seven issues and inspect the data, definitions, sources and limitations. It supports the article rather than replacing the explanation.

The article and dashboard are prepared. The separate sample email and LinkedIn post are optional extra examples, not required deliverables or commitments to contact anyone.

What the reader should take away

The reader should understand the main finding and why it could be worth reporting on. They should also understand that an event-day is a recorded protest on one date, not a participant, and that the earlier protest records cannot show whether the people surveyed in 2026 took action.

Optional outreach examples

These unsent examples are preserved as extra work. They are not required for the assignment and do not mean that any journalist contact or social publication is planned or completed.

Sample journalist email

Subject: Story idea: demand for Epstein accountability beyond the poll

Hi [journalist's name],

[Add one sentence connecting this project to a specific, verified piece of their reporting.]

In a February 2026 Navigator survey, 72% of US registered voters chose more investigations and prosecutions into people associated with Jeffrey Epstein and his criminal activities.

For a Berghs coursework project, I explored that finding alongside earlier US protest records. Our analysis found 491 event-days with Epstein-related demands in 2025, mostly about disclosure or cover-ups. Of those, 425 fell on 2 August, often within broader demonstrations.

That concentration suggests a question for further reporting: what helps turn calls for accountability into sustained public pressure? Interviews with organisers, alongside protest records from the same period as the poll, could help answer it.

The existing figures do not prove a gap between voters' opinions and their actions: the protest records predate the poll and mostly concern a different demand.

The short article, charts and source notes are here: [Above the law?](#). Would this be useful for a follow-up on accountability or protest organising?

Best,
Arvid Scarff

Sample LinkedIn post

72% of surveyed US registered voters chose more investigations and prosecutions in the Epstein case in February 2026.

What does that demand look like beyond a poll?

For my Berghs project, [Above the law?](#), I explored the finding alongside earlier US protest records. Those records mostly concern disclosure and predate the poll, so they cannot show whether these voters took action.

Explore the charts, sources and questions worth investigating: [Above the law?](#).

Accompanying chart

Use the supplied 72% chart card with the post. It shows the full response split rather than placing a percentage beside an unrelated protest count. Alt text: "Navigator survey of 1,000 US registered voters, 19–23 February 2026. More prosecutions and investigations: 72%; enough accountability / time to move on: 17%; unsure: 11%."

Draft status and source

These are unsent examples, not an outreach task list. Recipient details remain placeholders. The email's counts and limitations are documented in the article's data companion. Poll: [Navigator original results, p. 3; methods, p. 16](#).

Above the law?

Most surveyed voters want more action. What happens next?

In February 2026, 72% of surveyed US registered voters chose more investigations and prosecutions in the Epstein case. Earlier protest records offer context—but do not show how that demand translates into action.

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In a Navigator survey conducted on 19–23 February 2026, 72% of US registered voters chose more prosecutions and investigations into people associated with Jeffrey Epstein and his criminal activities. Another 17% chose enough accountability and time to move on; 11% were unsure.[1] This measures demand for further action, not just access to documents.

Our analysis found 491 US protest event-days with Epstein-related demands in 2025, mostly about disclosure or cover-ups rather than explicit prosecution.[2] These events predate the poll. They cannot show how voters acted on the demand measured in 2026.

For wider context, consider Gaza. In September 2025, 39% of US adults surveyed by Pew Research Center said Israel was going too far in its military operation against Hamas.[3] Our analysis found 8,953 protest event-days with Gaza or Palestinian-solidarity demands across the year.[2]

The figures prompt a question, not a ranking of how much people care: how is demand for investigations and prosecutions showing up in organised protest? Answering that needs protest evidence from the same period, with demands that match the poll.

A reason to look closer

The wider comparison includes immigration, racial justice, abortion, climate and Ukraine. Epstein is not the smallest protest category: its count is above abortion and reproductive rights, and just below Ukraine solidarity. The full picture matters, not only the most striking pair.[2][4]

There are several questions worth pursuing. Do some issues have stronger groups organising protests? Does an ongoing emergency make a difference? Do people need a clear demand and someone to organise around it? What role does news coverage play?

The figures do not answer those questions. Some of the contrast may also come from comparing one case with a much broader issue, or from differences in which protests were recorded.

What the numbers mean

The Epstein poll is from February 2026; the other polls and all event counts are from 2025. The questions, populations and demands differ. We cannot say these responses caused the protests or calculate what share of supporters took part. Wanting investigations and prosecutions does not mean everyone named in the files is guilty.

An event-day means one recorded protest on one date, not a person. Repeated protests can count on several dates, and one protest can cover several issues. Of the 491 Epstein records, 425 fall on 2 August, often within broader demonstrations.[2]

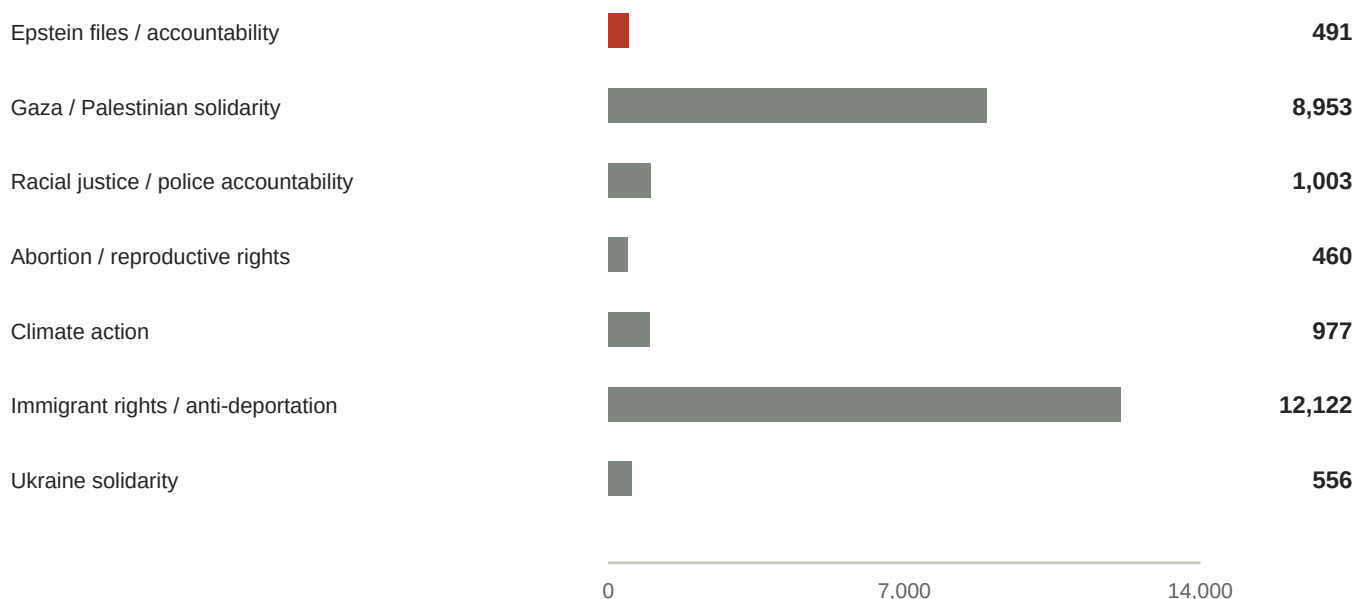
That leaves a question, rather than a verdict about how much people care: **what helps turn a demand for accountability into sustained public action?**

Explore the charts and check the sources in the interactive investigation.

Data companion

Recorded US protest event-days

2025 · 50 states + DC · Event-days with matching demands



Recorded in-person protests, 1 January–31 December 2025, in the 50 US states and Washington, DC. We reviewed the demands in Crowd Counting Consortium v18.0 records and grouped them by issue; these are our counts, not official CCC movement totals. Repeat dates and protests covering several issues can contribute to the counts. Categories overlap. The figures do not count people or only protests devoted to a single issue. Of the 491 Epstein records, 425 fall on 2 August. Most concern disclosure, not explicit prosecution; all predate the February 2026 poll. Source: [2].

Sources and calculation notes

[1] **Navigator / Global Strategy Group, 19–23 February 2026.** Online survey of 1,000 US registered voters, recruited through an opt-in panel and verified against a voter file. Asked which side they agreed with more, 72% chose: “There should be more prosecutions and investigations into people associated with Jeffrey Epstein and his criminal activities.” The alternatives were enough accountability/time to move on (17%) and not sure (11%). Publisher-reported margin: ± 3.1 percentage points (95%); this does not cover all sources of error.

[Original poll: results p. 3, methods p. 16](#)

[2] **Crowd Counting Consortium, U.S. Protest Event Data, 2025–, v18.0.** Released 10 September 2026. We selected 2025 in-person records in the 50 states and DC, searched for relevant demands, and reviewed the wording to exclude ambiguous or opposing claims. Each record counts once per category. Coverage varies, differently worded demands may be missed, and scheduled repeat events may not each have been reconfirmed. This is not a complete count of all protests.

[Versioned dataset](#) · [Matched records](#) · [Coding decisions](#)

[3] **Pew Research Center, 22–28 September 2025.** Survey of 3,445 US adults. Asked about Israel’s current military operation against Hamas, 39% answered “Going too far.” Full-sample margin of error: ± 1.9 percentage points.

[Original poll, p. 8](#) · [Report and methodology](#)

[4] **Seven selected polls.** Navigator (February 2026) plus six 2025 polls from Pew, AP-NORC and Gallup. The Epstein response replaces document-release support because it measures demand for more action. Dates, questions, populations and methods differ; these snapshots are not annual averages or a shared measure of concern. This is a selected comparison, not an exhaustive review. No respondents are linked to protest records.

[Exact questions, dates and methods](#) · [Comparison CSV](#)

Opinion & activity

What might explain public action?

Navigator's 72% measures demand for more investigations and prosecutions in February 2026. The other polls and all event counts are from 2025. Epstein events mostly concern disclosure, not explicit prosecution. This is historical context, not a matched accountability-to-protest comparison.

Cause	Selected poll response / source	Opinion	Event-days
Epstein files / accountability	Want more investigations and prosecutions in the Epstein case Navigator / Global Strategy Group · 19–23 Feb 2026	72%	491
Gaza / Palestinian solidarity	Say Israel is going too far in its military operation against Hamas Pew Research Center · 22–28 Sep 2025	39%	8,953
Racial justice / police accountability	Strongly or somewhat support Black Lives Matter Pew Research Center · 10–17 Feb 2025	52%	1,003
Abortion / reproductive rights	Say abortion should be legal in all or most cases AP-NORC · 10–14 Jul 2025	64%	460
Climate action	Worry a great deal or a fair amount about climate change Gallup · 3–16 Mar 2025	63%	977
Immigrant rights / anti-deportation	Oppose deporting all immigrants living in the US illegally AP-NORC · 10–14 Jul 2025	40%	12,122
Ukraine solidarity	Prefer US support for Ukraine reclaiming territory, even if war lasts longer Gallup · 1–15 Aug 2025	52%	556

The polls ask different things. Supporting a policy, supporting a movement and worrying about climate change are not the same. The Epstein poll covers US registered voters; the others cover US adults. We do not know whether respondents attended any of these protests.

Rounding: AP-NORC publishes 64% for abortion legal in all/most cases. Its separately rounded 25% and 38% components sum to 63%; the table retains the published net. All source links are clickable. Exact questions, samples and uncertainty are in the interactive investigation and comparison JSON/CSV.

Event counts: same CCC classification and full-year scope as the preceding page. Recurring events and coalition demands contribute records, categories overlap, and a single case differs in scope from broad movements. These are not participants or unique campaigns.

Explore the charts, data and methods in the [interactive investigation](#). This package supports the content plan; outreach examples are optional.